

Clockwise from right: Ganesh Emporium's 300-year-old haveli is a hotbed of pichwai revival; Alark Lall's zardozi artisans at work

done by Nivritti Kumari Mewar, from the royal family of Mewar (Udaipur), who has been patronising Sambalpuri ikat through her contemporary design brand, Vottary. Sambalpuri ikat is a lesser known form of ikat, practised by weavers in her home state of Odisha. She works with a team of Odisha-based master craftsmen to create modern interpretations of Sambalpuri ikat creations such as clothing, bags, accessories and trunks. In the bargain, Mewar has created an interest for a traditional art form, interpreted and translated beautifully and effortlessly to a modern context. This holds particularly true for the city of Udaipur, where so many ancient art forms continue to be kept alive such as pichwai, miniature paintings, wood carving, glass work and block printing.

Another interesting story reverberating from a 17th century haveli in Udaipur, traces back to Vipul Shah, who has become something of a social media craze for his iconic, colourful bags; few people know the artistic heritage that he and his family belong to. Shah's family enterprise, Ganesh Emporium, is a labyrinth of pichwai art with dozens of mini galleries that are dedicated entirely to the ancient form of pichwai housed in almost a 100 rooms. Vipul's brother, Viral Shah, walks me through the multitude of galleries, terraces and rooms